



Easy Zucchini Dessert Recipes With Cream Cheese for a Moist, Flavorful Treat

If you've got zucchini and cream cheese on hand, you're just minutes away from a moist, irresistibly creamy dessert. This recipe balances fresh zucchini's subtle earthiness with rich cream cheese swirls for a perfect treat. Great for afternoon snacks or casual get-togethers!



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15 min
PREP



30 min
COOK



45 min
TOTAL



8
SERVINGS



Easy
DIFFICULTY

Ingredients

- ☐ 2 cups grated zucchini, squeezed dry
- ☐ 8 oz cream cheese, softened
- ☐ 1 cup granulated sugar
- ☐ 2 large eggs
- ☐ 1 1/2 cups all-purpose flour
- ☐ 1 tsp baking powder

- ☐ 1/2 tsp baking soda
- ☐ 1/2 tsp salt
- ☐ 1 tsp vanilla extract
- ☐ 1/2 tsp ground cinnamon
- ☐ 1/4 cup vegetable oil

Instructions

- 1** Start by grating the zucchini and then squeezing out as much moisture as possible using a clean kitchen towel or cheesecloth. This step is crucial because zucchini holds a lot of water, and removing excess moisture prevents your dessert from becoming soggy. Once drained, set the zucchini aside. This ensures your batter stays thick and the texture remains tender but not wet. ⌚ 10
- 2** In a mixing bowl, beat the softened cream cheese with half the sugar until smooth and creamy. This creates the luscious swirls that add richness and tang. Then, in a separate bowl, whisk together the eggs, remaining sugar, oil, and vanilla extract until combined. Mixing these wet ingredients well helps ensure even distribution of flavors and moisture throughout the batter. ⌚ 5
- 3** In another bowl, sift together the flour, baking powder, baking soda, salt, and cinnamon. Sifting aerates the flour and evenly distributes the leavening agents and spices, which is essential for a light, evenly risen dessert. Carefully fold the dry ingredients into the wet mixture, mixing just until combined to avoid overworking the batter and developing gluten which can make the dessert tough. ⌚ 5
- 4** Fold the drained zucchini into the batter gently. The zucchini adds moisture and texture without overwhelming the batter. Be careful not to overmix here to keep the batter light and tender. The green flecks will be visible throughout, indicating a fresh, vibrant dessert. ⌚ 3
- 5** Preheat your oven to 350°F (175°C) and grease or line an 8x8 inch baking pan with parchment paper. This prevents sticking and ensures easy removal of your dessert after baking. Pour half the batter into the pan, then dollop half the cream cheese mixture on top. Use a knife or skewer to swirl the cream cheese gently into the batter, creating a marbled effect. ⌚ 7
- 6** Repeat layering with the remaining batter and cream cheese mixture, swirling again for a beautiful marbled top. This layering technique gives you pockets of creamy richness in every bite and an appealing look that makes the dessert feel special. ⌚ 3

- 7** Bake in the preheated oven for 30–35 minutes or until a toothpick inserted in the center comes out mostly clean with just a few moist crumbs. Baking time can vary depending on your oven, so start checking at 30 minutes. The edges should be golden and firm while the center remains moist but set. ⏱ 30
- 8** Let the dessert cool completely in the pan on a wire rack. Cooling allows the cream cheese to set fully and the flavors to meld, resulting in a more cohesive texture when sliced. Cutting too soon can cause the cream cheese to ooze out and the dessert to crumble. ⏱ 30
- 9** Once cooled, cut into squares and serve. This dessert pairs wonderfully with a cup of tea or coffee. You can dust the top with a little powdered sugar or cinnamon for extra flair. Store leftovers in an airtight container in the fridge to keep it fresh and creamy. ⏱ 5

Chef Tips

❏ Always squeeze out the zucchini after grating.

Zucchini contains a lot of water that can make your dessert soggy if not removed. Squeezing it out ensures the batter stays thick and the final texture tender but not wet. If you skip this step, the dessert may not set properly and can become dense.

❏ Use softened cream cheese at room temperature.

Softened cream cheese blends smoothly into the batter, creating beautiful swirls and a creamy texture. Cold cream cheese can clump and create uneven pockets, while over-softened or melted cream cheese can break down the batter structure.

❏ Fold ingredients gently to avoid overmixing.

Overmixing activates gluten in the flour, which can make the dessert tough and chewy. Gentle folding keeps the batter light and tender, allowing the zucchini and cream cheese to shine without a dense texture.

❏ Use fresh baking powder and baking soda.

Leavening agents lose potency over time. Fresh baking powder and soda ensure your dessert rises properly, resulting in a fluffy texture. Old leavening can cause a dense or flat dessert.

☒ Let the dessert cool completely before slicing.

Cooling allows the cream cheese to set and the dessert to firm up, making it easier to cut clean squares. Cutting too soon can cause the cream cheese to ooze and the dessert to crumble.

☒ Add a cinnamon dusting for extra flavor.

A light sprinkle of cinnamon on top before baking enhances the dessert's aroma and adds a warm spice note that complements the zucchini and cream cheese perfectly.

☒ Use an 8x8 inch pan for even baking.

An 8x8 inch pan provides the ideal thickness for this dessert, ensuring it bakes evenly without drying out. Using a larger pan will make it thinner and could result in overbaking.

Storage & Reheating

☒ Refrigerator

Store in an airtight container in the refrigerator for up to 4 days. The dessert will firm up and the cream cheese swirls become more pronounced. Serve chilled or at room temperature for best flavor.

❄ Freezer

Freeze the dessert wrapped tightly in plastic wrap and aluminum foil for up to 2 months. To thaw, transfer to the refrigerator overnight. Avoid freezing for longer as texture may degrade.

☒ Reheating

Reheat individual slices gently in the microwave for 15-20 seconds or in a 300°F oven for 10 minutes. Avoid overheating to prevent drying out. A light splash of milk can be added before reheating to restore moisture.

Nutrition (per serving)

320 kcal CALORIES	6g PROTEIN	38g CARBS
16g FAT	2g FIBER	280mg SODIUM

Nutritional values are estimates and may vary based on specific ingredients used.

Thank You

Thank you for choosing this recipe collection. We hope it brings warmth and flavor to your kitchen.



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